

FOUNDATIONS PROGRAM · AGES 8 +

Foundations *Curriculum Guide*

A complete reference for what the program develops, how the four phases of mechanical training work, and how to enroll. Built around movement first, governed by effort bands, and earned phase by phase.

ISSUED BY

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REFERENCE

tapathletes.com/foundations

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ABOUT THIS GUIDE

A structured, progression-based *pitching development* program for ages 8 and up.

This guide is the academy's reference for parents, athletes, and coaches. It covers what the program *develops*, how training is *placed and progressed*, which classes are included, and the two enrollment formats.

§ Contents In this *guide*.

7 sections · 18 skills

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“Phases describe what the pitcher is working on — not their age or experience level. All new pitchers begin in Phase 1, regardless of background.”

— FOUNDATIONS METHODOLOGY

THE PREMISE

Mechanics + Classes

The *complete* pitcher.

Foundations develops the whole pitcher through a structured mechanical curriculum, paired with included classes covering *everything else the position demands* — pitch design, game knowledge, and positional responsibilities.

MECHANICS — 4 PHASES GOVERNED BY EFFORT BANDS

phase ≠ age

Each phase corresponds to an **effort band** — a defined range of throwing intensity expressed as a percentage of the pitcher's recent representative maximum. Phases describe what the pitcher is *working on*, not their age or experience level.

01

PHASE

Movement & Throwing *Foundations*

Learning what the positions feel like. Skills are introduced at low effort through movement-first drills — static holds, controlled weight shifts, and plyo ball work. The pitcher is not chasing velocity. They are building a proprioceptive map of how each movement should feel before any intensity is added.

EFFORT BAND 1

30–50%

02

PHASE

Stability & *Transfer*

Can they hold it under load? Skills are reinforced with increased effort and rotational demand. Flat-ground and mound throwing with constraint focus. The question shifts from “can they do it?” to “can they repeat it?” Advancement requires demonstrated stability — not just attendance.

EFFORT BAND 2

50–70%

03

PHASE

Command & *Intent Development*

Mechanics meet purpose. Full mound work with quadrant targeting, effort ladders, and pitch-to-pitch sequencing. The pitcher must maintain their trained patterns while commanding the ball to specific locations. Self-assessment and internal awareness become primary training tools.

EFFORT BAND 3

70–85%

INCLUDED FREE

2 classes · ongoing

Beyond *mechanics*.

The game doesn't stop when the pitch crosses the plate. Classes cover the parts of pitching that don't show up in a velocity reading — *included free* for Foundations members.

— CLASS 01 · PITCH DESIGN

Sequencing & Mix Creation

— *think like a pitcher, not a thrower.*

How to build a pitch mix that works in sequence, not just individually. Pitchers learn to think like pitchers instead of just throwing harder.

- Sequence pitches to create deception and tunnel effectively
- Build a mix around your actual stuff, not a template
- Make smarter count-based decisions
- Read hitters and adjust mid-outing

— CLASS 02 · COMPLETE PITCHER

Beyond the Pitch

— *what a pitcher is responsible for, end to end.*

Everything a pitcher is responsible for that doesn't show up in a velocity reading.

- Pickoff mechanics and holding runners
- Backup responsibilities on throws and wild pitches
- Fielding your position — PFPs and game situations
- Communicating with your catcher and infield

*“Velocity is a number. Pitching is a craft. Classes exist so the pitcher leaves the academy able to **do the job** — not just throw the ball.”*

— ON THE ROLE OF CLASSES

CADENCE

Classes run on a rolling schedule throughout the year. Members attend at any cadence that fits their training week.

FORMAT

Small-group instruction at the TAP Athletes facility. Whiteboard work, video review, and live application on the mound.

COST

Included free with Standard or Hybrid Foundations program. No additional fee, no à-la-carte add-ons.

01

Movement & Throwing Foundations

PROPRIOCEPTION · MOVEMENT-FIRST DRILLS · LOW INTENSITY

EFFORT BAND 1

30 – 50%

SUBPHASE A LOWER BODY & FORCE TRANSFER

A1	<i>Front-Leg Stability</i>	Front-Leg Post Hold · Walk-In Plyo Ball Throw to Freeze · Flat-Ground Controlled Throw with Freeze · Self-Assessment Rep
A2	<i>Drive Leg Extension</i>	Wall Press Drive-Leg Extension · Drive-Leg Load & Hover · Flat-Ground Throw with Drive-Leg Focus · “Best Rep” Identification
A3	<i>Hip-to-Shoulder Separation</i>	Seated Trunk Rotation · Standing Separation Walk-Through · Rocker PlyoCare Pivot Throw · Step-Behind PlyoCare Throw
A4	<i>Pelvic Rotation</i>	Wall-Supported Stride-to-Hip-Turn · Partner Mirror Drill · Rocker Throw with Hip-Lead Focus · Pivot Pickoff with Pelvic Emphasis
A5	<i>Stride Direction & Momentum</i>	Stride-Only Delivery Reps · Stride-to-Target with Guided Hip Lead · Plyo Ball Step-and-Throw to Line · Regulation Baseball Stride-and-Throw

SUBPHASE C SEQUENCING & INTEGRATION

C1	<i>Hip-to-Shoulder Separation Timing</i>	Medicine Ball Load-and-Hold · Standing Separation Drill · Pivot Pickoff with Separation Focus · Rocker Throw with Separation Focus
C2	<i>Arm Timing Relative to Hip Rotation</i>	Wall Hip Rotation with Passive Arm · Rocker Hip Rotation · Step-Behind Throw with Pause · Hip-Tap Throw
C3	<i>Trunk Tilt & Forward Flexion</i>	Wall-Guided Lateral Trunk Tilt · PVC Pipe Forward Flexion Hinge · Tall Kneeling Throws · Split-Stance Throws · Partner Freeze-Frame
C4	<i>Balance Point & Rocker Mechanics</i>	Static Balance-Point Hold · Eyes-Closed Balance-Point Hold · Walk-Through Rocker to Balance · Rocker to Balance on 2×4 Board · Rocker-to-Balance-to-Toss

03

Command & *Intent* Development

MOUND WORK · QUADRANT TARGETING · SEQUENCING

EFFORT BAND 3

70 – 85%

SUBPHASE A LOWER BODY & FORCE TRANSFER

A1	<i>Front-Leg Stability</i>	Step-Behind to Brace Throw · Stretch Delivery to Called Quadrant · Three-Pitch Intent Ladders (70 → 78 → 85%)
A2	<i>Drive Leg Extension</i>	Half-Kneeling PlyoCare Throws · Half-Foam Roller Drive-Leg Push-Off · PlyoCare Rocker & Step-Behind Throws · Mound Fastballs to Quadrant Targets · Mound Fastballs with Self-Called Locations
A3	<i>Hip-to-Shoulder Separation</i>	Walk-In PlyoCare Pivot Pickoff · Rocker Throws with Separation Hold · Mound Delivery with “Hips First” Checkpoint · Targeted Four-Quadrant Fastballs · Three-Pitch Sequences
A4	<i>Pelvic Rotation</i>	Step-and-Brace Pelvic Rotation · Crow-Hop Throws with Pelvic Timing · Mound Fastball Command Series · Three-Pitch Sequencing Challenge
A5	<i>Stride Direction & Momentum</i>	Corridor Stride Throws · Mound Corridor Throws with Half-Zone Targeting · Sequenced Quadrant Command with Internalized Stride Corridor

SUBPHASE C SEQUENCING & INTEGRATION

C1	<i>Hip-to-Shoulder Separation Timing</i>	Step-Behind Rocker Throw · Band-Resisted Trunk Rotation · PlyoCare Step-Back with Verbal Timing Call · Tempo-Varied Delivery · Mound Separation-to-Spot · 3-and-3 Challenge
C2	<i>Arm Timing Relative to Hip Rotation</i>	Seated Rotational Throw · Walking Wind-Up to Hip Stall · Full Delivery with Timing Self-Rating · Mound Throws with Quadrant Targeting · Three-Pitch Sequence with Intent Hold
C3	<i>Trunk Tilt & Forward Flexion</i>	Rocker PlyoCare with Trunk Bias · Step-Behind with Forward Flexion Focus · Targeted Mound Throws — Glove Side Low / Arm Side Low · Challenge Round — 5 of 8
C4	<i>Balance Point & Rocker Mechanics</i>	Slow-Motion Rocker Walk-Through with Pause · Rocker-to-Balance with Cone Touch · Mound Rocker “Rhythm Throws” · Quadrant Calling — “Pattern First, Location Second” · “3-in-a-Row” Challenge

THE FRAMEWORK

18 skills • 4 categories

18 skills. 4 categories. Every phase.

The same eighteen mechanical skills are trained at every phase — only the *effort, complexity, and integration* change. A pitcher in Phase 1 and a pitcher in Phase 4 are working on Front-Leg Stability; they are simply training it under different conditions.

A LOWER BODY & FORCE TRANSFER A1 Front-Leg Stability A2 Drive Leg Extension A3 Hip-to-Shoulder Separation A4 Pelvic Rotation A5 Stride Direction & Momentum	B ARM ACTION & UPPER BODY B1 Arm Path & Hand Break Timing B2 Scapular Loading B3 External Rotation & Layback B4 Arm Acceleration & Internal Rotation B5 Glove-Side Control & Deceleration
C SEQUENCING & FULL-BODY INTEGRATION C1 Hip-to-Shoulder Separation Timing C2 Arm Timing Relative to Hip Rotation C3 Trunk Tilt & Forward Flexion C4 Balance Point & Rocker Mechanics	D COMMAND & PITCH EXECUTION D1 Repeatable Release Point D2 Rhythm & Timing Consistency D3 Mound Presence & Intent Management D4 Stretch vs. Windup Mechanics

“A pitcher may be placed into *different phases for different skills* based on their individual development — placement is *per-skill, not per-pitcher*.”

FROM INQUIRY TO TRAINING

4 steps • structured

The *process*.

Every pitcher follows the same structured entry point. The system *evaluates where they are, places them correctly, and builds from there.*

1

STEP ONE

Assessment — 90-minute in-person evaluation, free.

Every pitcher begins with a free, 90-minute in-person evaluation. The assessment covers training history, pitch repertoire, a full warm-up with movement quality grading, four athleticism benchmarks (broad jump, single-leg balance, rotational med ball throw, 10-yard acceleration), and a flat-ground throwing observation. No one skips this step — it produces the starting point for everything that follows.

2

STEP TWO

Placement — phase, subphase, and effort band.

Based on the assessment, your pitcher is placed into the right phase and subphase. Effort bands are assigned using the pitcher's recent representative maximum throwing velocity — not age, not experience, and not what a parent reports on the phone. The coach manages placement using observable signals: movement quality at current effort, effort awareness, recent throwing exposure, and recovery feedback. A pitcher may be placed into different phases for different skills based on their individual development.

3

STEP THREE

Reserved Weekly *Training*.

Training times are assigned in advance — no weekly booking, no scrambling for availability. Sessions can take place at our facility or, for Hybrid members, the coach comes to your pitcher's home, park, or field. The schedule is built around your family, not the other way around.

4

STEP FOUR

Advance When *Ready*.

No pitcher moves to the next phase just by attending. Advancement is earned by demonstrating the ability to perform and repeat what's being trained. The coach signs off;

TWO FORMATS

Standard · Hybrid

Two formats. Same progression.

Both options begin with an in-person assessment and follow the same Foundations curriculum. The only difference is *where training happens*.

STANDARD · ALL-FACILITY

The *Standard* Plan

\$510 / month

Every session at the TAP Athletes facility. Full access to equipment and a controlled training environment.

- ✓ 2 sessions / week recommended
- ✓ Up to 8 sessions per month
- ✓ Reserved weekly time slots
- ✓ Classes included free

FLEXIBLE · HYBRID

The *Hybrid* Plan

\$600 / month

Facility sessions plus up to 4 on-site visits per month — coach comes to your pitcher's home, park, or field.

- ✓ All facility sessions included
- ✓ Up to 4 on-site sessions / month
- ✓ Same progression — no gaps
- ✓ Classes included free

INTRODUCTORY · FOUNDATIONS PREP

A one-month *entry point*.

For younger pitchers, beginners, or families new to structured training. Two 30-minute sessions per week. After one month, pitchers transition into the full program.

2 × / WEEK
30 MIN SESSIONS
1-MONTH COMMITMENT
AGES 8 – 12